

\$1B CEO: 8 rules I wish I knew in my 20s

Channel: Greg Lav · Published: Sep 05, 2026 · Watch: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=V-iMQ2ktX7k> Source: full transcript

Executive Summary

Greg Lav, 31-year-old co-founder of Bloom (projected 9-figure revenue per portfolio in 2026), delivers 8 unfiltered rules for young entrepreneurs: master saying no, learn by observation, execute over talking, stay consistent, audit routines every 6 months, reject fake dopamine, stop abandoning projects early, and trust the meritocracy.

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Introduction: Who Greg Is and Why This Channel Exists 0:00

- Greg opens with a blunt framing: the average American male is overweight, divorced, and making \$70K/year
 - He's not speaking to people content with that path — he's speaking to people chasing a "moonshot"
 - A moonshot = a generational run where you lock in for a decade, change your family tree, affect culture
- **His company:** Bloom, co-founded with his wife in 2019
 - Three portfolios: energy drinks, Bloom Pop Soda, and nutrition
 - Each portfolio projected to do over **9 figures** in 2026
 - Will sell over **half a billion cans** of their beverage in its second year of nationwide availability — now also global
- He's 31 years old and describes himself as still fully "in the arena"
- His stated mission for this channel: pass down lessons from his 10-year journey so viewers can be further ahead after their own decade
- Core thesis of this video: **discipline over easy dopamine**

- Filmed at the top of Ajax Mountain in Aspen, Colorado, looking at ~30 privately owned jets worth \$20–\$90 million each
 - Old mindset: "Must be nice, they got lucky" → he calls this victim mentality
 - New mindset required: "If somebody else has done it, why can't I?"
- Notes the arena is wide open in 2026: technology is democratized, social media creates TikTok millionaires, Amazon millionaires, and omnichannel operators like himself

🚫 Rule 1: Master the Word "No" 2:60

- **"No" is the most powerful word and skill you can learn at the beginning of your journey**
- He is known in his social/professional circle for being exceptionally good at saying no — not because he's antisocial, but because he understands opportunity cost
- In the beginning, you cannot effectively balance multiple things:
 - Going out and drinking 3x a week
 - Chasing relationships for distraction
 - Traveling for clout while pretending to build something
 - Saying yes to every social obligation
- Analogy: his 8-month-old son learning to crawl cannot hold something while crawling — it requires all his focus
 - "You cannot walk and chew gum at the same time" at the start of your journey
- The principle of abstinence over moderation:
 - Easier to cut carbs entirely than to "eat a few carbs"
 - Easier to not drink at all than to "just have a few drinks"
 - Easier to not socialize for 3–12 months than to socialize a few times a week
- Prescription: take a step back to take 30 steps forward — dedicate months to laser focus and practicing saying no
- The obligation feeling to say yes comes from prior generations defining "balance" — but there is no balance in the beginning of a life of pursuit
- The payoff: in 5–10 years you get to say yes to the things that actually matter — family, relationships, enjoying life
- He references the "winter arc" (October–November–December, 90 days) as a 3-month window to lock in
 - Frames it not as a fitness challenge but as a **moonshot challenge** — time to become capable of handling your goals

👁️ Rule 2: Learn by Example (Not by Asking) 6:00

- Everyone talks about "leading by example" — nobody talks about **learning by example**
- He gets bombarded with DMs, comments, emails, even WhatsApp messages asking for advice — he doesn't respond because experts in their own business aren't experts in yours

- "I'm an expert in Bloom. I'm not an expert in your business."
- His actual method for studying competitors and successful brands:
 - Order their product on their website
 - Observe what the email flow looks like
 - Examine the packaging when it arrives
 - Go to the **Facebook Ad Library** (public, free) and see all their ads — identify which ones are being republished month after month
 - Search their brand on TikTok to find which influencers they're working with
 - Find patterns in their strategy and apply a version of it to his own brand
- Key point: **"The arena is public. It is all accessible to all of us."**
 - Facebook Ad Library is public
 - Amazon listings are public
 - Their email flow is public (spend \$30 to buy their product)
- Personal example from upbringing: his parents weren't entrepreneurs, but they woke up early, never skipped appointments, showed up consistently — they never talked about it, they just did it, and that's how he now parents his son
- His real mentors: people he watches, not people he has dinner with
 - "I don't have any mentors or apprentices. What I have is people that I watch."
- Critical nuance on copying routines:
 - A young entrepreneur asked if he should copy the daily routines of millionaires ("LARP the routine")
 - **You need to copy what successful people did at the beginning of their journey, not what they do now**
 - Successful people's routines at their current level look very different from what got them there
 - Greg acknowledges he's an unusual case — his current day still looks similar to earlier days because he hasn't taken his foot off the gas

✓ **Rule 3: Do What You Say You're Going to Do 10:12**

- "Do not be the person that just talks about it. Be the person that does it."
- Modern culture rewards talking about goals on social media — announcing you're locked in, quitting your job, starting a venture
 - This produces cheap, fake dopamine
 - Six months later, those people have nothing to show for it
- His personal rule on social media: **talk about what you've done and what you're doing, not what you plan to do**
 - He rarely states future goals publicly
 - He never talks about how he's going to get jacked or be a great dad — he shows it

- Working in silence ("monk mode") and coming back 3, 6, or 12 months later with the thing actually achieved feels **10x better** than announcing it
- Make being the person who actually does the thing a **foundational habit** — if you keep it consistent, you will be unrecognizable every 6 months

Rule 4: Consistency — In the Right Things 11:21

- Consistency is key — but the direction matters
 - Example: a 350-lb man hitting McDonald's drive-thru every day is consistent — just in the wrong thing
 - You're probably already consistent; the question is whether it's in the right things
- Why consistency matters:
 - Once you get a taste of success, you'll want to take your foot off the gas — that's when you lose the consistency that got you there
 - This is why people hit \$100K, \$1M, even \$10M and plateau
- Bloom in 2026 does more **every single week** than the company did in its entire first year of business — that's the power of compounding consistency
- Don't be the person who starts over a million times — compounding only works if you stay in it

Rule 5: Audit Your Routines Every 6 Months 12:53

- Every 6 months, ask: what does my average day look like? What is working and what isn't?
 - Keep what's working; cut what isn't
- This is not about morning routines and ice baths — this is about **large structural changes** to your consistent day-to-day
- Personal cautionary example:
 - When he and his wife launched Bloom in Boulder, Colorado, he worked hard every day and then smoked weed every night to "turn off" — did this for **18 months**
 - Convinced himself it was a good ritual to decompress
 - Only after leaving Boulder did he realize: weed was making him less productive
 - **The moment he stopped, his efficiency skyrocketed** — what used to take 12 hours now takes 3 hours
- In the beginning, 12-hour days are normal because you haven't developed efficiency yet — that's okay, it's how it starts
- Audit can reveal it's not just substances — it might be:
 - The significant other you're with
 - Your friend group
 - The social media accounts you follow (people who make you jealous → emotional decisions instead of logical ones)
 - Unfollow those people; remove those relationships

- As income grows, outsource time-wasting tasks:
 - Meal prep / food delivery
 - House cleaning
 - "Why am I wasting 2 hours a day cooking and cleaning when I can outsource these things?"
- At early stages, a zero-cost version of auditing might be: pack your bags and move to a new state
- There will always be something to audit at every level of the game
- Over a 10-year period, 6-month audits = **20 significant changes** to your environment and habits
 - Every time he made those changes, his life leveled up drastically

Rule 6: Chase Real Dopamine, Not Fake Dopamine 16:42

- Society is not just offering fake dopamine — it is **bombarding** you with it
 - Social media, pornography, fast food, alcohol, Netflix, video games
 - "Don't fall for that. It's a trap."
- The most painful version of this trap: looking in the mirror at the man you could have become
- Fake dopamine also includes:
 - Posting on social media about your goals before achieving them
 - Announcing a diet, a gym plan, a new venture
 - Surrounding yourself with people who make you feel good but don't make you better
- **Real dopamine** = fulfillment from actual achievement:
 - Doing whatever you want on a Tuesday morning
 - Having family and homes around the world
 - Taking care of loved ones and your team
 - Walking into an office every day excited to be there, working with your best friends
- The key distinction: fake dopamine gives you a feeling; real dopamine gives you **fulfillment**
 - Fulfillment is what you want at age 70 looking back

"You won't just feel dopamine, you'll feel fulfillment. And that is what I want for you."

Rule 7: Stop Starting New Things 18:38

- You are planting seeds today whose output you won't see for **6, 12, or even 36 months**
- Bloom's current product is the result of a **7-year pursuit** (started 2019)
 - In 2026 it does more every week than the entire first year of business
 - Imagine if he had quit 6 months in — "no one created anything special in 6 months"
- The dopamine hit from progress is **delayed** — that's uncomfortable but it's how real compounding works
- The inverse is also true: bad decisions made today won't surface as consequences for **6–12 months**

- Example: a 2-week beach vacation would feel fine in the moment, but the revenue slowdown from coasting wouldn't be felt until 6 months later
- Fitness analogy: stopping bench press after 2 workouts because you're not stronger yet
 - You don't make progress in the gym in 2 weeks; you make progress in **2 years**
 - That's how you build a physique of respect — same logic applies to a business
- He is a fan of "giving up the good for the great" — pivoting is valid — but things need time to blossom before you can even evaluate
- The trap he used to fall into: smoking weed and watching Netflix to escape problems
 - Problems don't disappear when you escape — they turn into forest fires
 - **"The only answer is action. The only way through is through."**

Rule 8: The World Is a Meritocracy — Act Like It 21:23

- "The universe we live in today is a meritocracy. It rewards hard work."
- Nobody with private jets, sports cars, or the life you want was simply lucky
- His own credentials on paper are unremarkable:
 - Graduated college with a **2.4 GPA**
 - His wife dropped out and then graduated with a similarly low GPA
 - "Nothing on paper makes sense about our success."
- The previous generation's script was a lie: get good grades → 401K → retire at 70 on a beach
 - His response: "I want to live that life now when I'm 30."
- When he recognized that the arena doors are wide open regardless of age or experience, his life changed
- Mantra to repeat when you see success others have built: **"If somebody else has done it, why can't I?"**
- Honest observation about successful people: they often don't even know exactly what's making them successful — they're just doing more of what the universe has rewarded them for
- Real-time arena insight he discovered recently by studying TikTok Shop and Amazon:
 - **Mom-and-pop authenticity is winning** right now — not legacy corporate polish
 - He's seeing brands with customer service emails like kylie@gmail.com or kylie@theirbrand.com outperforming polished corporate operations
 - The previous generation told you to mimic legacy brands; the 2026 arena rewards being authentic and human
 - "The more you can make your stuff look real and less like a publicly traded stock, the more you can win"
 - He discovered this by studying himself — not by calling anyone and asking their strategy
- Closing: Greg LeVekia, making this channel to pass down hard-learned lessons so viewers are further ahead 10 years into their own journey
 - Goal: one video per week
 - "You are capable of doing anything that any other man or woman has ever achieved."